Cardiff Business Growth Expo 2026 - Keynote Stage

Event: **Thursday 29th October 2026** - **Cardiff City Stadium**

09:30 AM - 10:00 AM

Councillor Michael Michael
Lord Mayor of Cardiff

10:00 AM - 11:00 AM

Santosh Kumar
Author & Wealth Mindset Coach, B2B Growth Hub

Session: The Million-Pound Whisper: 12 Stages to Wealth Mastery

EMCEE INTRO
Our first keynote speaker is someone who has built businesses, scaled them, and now teaches others how to do the same.
A Forbes Council member and Global CEO of B2B Growth Hub, he is known for combining strategic growth with deep personal transformation.
Please welcome Santosh Kumar.

About the Speaker
Santosh Kumar is a serial entrepreneur, author, and wealth mindset coach. As Global CEO of B2B Growth Hub, he has helped businesses unlock growth through strategy, digital transformation, and customer-centric thinking. His work focuses on bridging internal mindset with external execution to drive measurable success.

About the Session
Most people chase money. Very few understand how wealth is actually built. This session breaks down a 12-stage blueprint to achieving your first—or next—million. It focuses on the skills most people ignore: emotional discipline, high-value networking, and decision-making under pressure. Expect a structured, actionable roadmap—not motivation.

Speaker Contact
Phone: 447454675398

Continued on next page...

PANEL DISCUSSION 1

Marketing & Market Positioning

Attention Is Harder to Earn Than Ever: Why Most Brands Are Becoming Forgettable

11:00 AM - 11:45 AM | Main Keynote Stage

About the Panel

Attention Is Harder to Earn Than Ever: Why Most Brands Are Becoming Forgettable. Businesses are producing more content than ever before. Yet visibility, trust, and customer attention are becoming harder to win. The brands growing fastest in 2026 are not necessarily spending the most on advertising - they are building stronger positioning, emotional relevance, and memorable market presence. This panel explores how modern businesses can stand out in crowded markets where audiences are overwhelmed by constant messaging, AI-generated content, and endless competition for attention.

Questions to Address:

1. Why are so many businesses becoming visually and strategically identical?
2. What makes people remember a business after seeing it once?
3. Is personal branding now becoming essential for founders?
4. What type of marketing still performs in saturated markets?
5. Are businesses creating too much content without enough positioning?
6. What creates trust faster: authority, storytelling, or consistency?
7. Is polished corporate branding becoming less effective?
8. If your marketing budget disappeared tomorrow, how would you generate demand?

EMCEE INTRO

Businesses are producing more content than ever before.
Yet visibility, trust, and customer attention are becoming harder to win.
The brands growing fastest in 2026 are not necessarily spending the most on advertising — they are building stronger positioning, emotional relevance, and memorable market presence.
This panel explores how modern businesses can stand out in crowded markets where audiences are overwhelmed by constant messaging, AI-generated content, and endless competition for attention.

Continued on next page...

Panelists

Tracy Ho

Founder, Frame & Fame Personal Branding

Tracy Ho is an Executive Presence Coach & Personal Branding Strategist helping professionals & entrepreneurs communicate their value more clearly, strengthen visibility, & build greater confidence, credibility, & influence for their business growth.

Phone: 447473686361

Keila Costa

Neuro Architect & Founder, BrainBridg_

Keila Costa, founder of BrainBridg_, is an autistic ADHD advocate and Autism Specialist helping organisations build inclusive systems through lived experience and professional expertise. Operating across the UK, Brazil, USA, and EU, her “Cascade Method” improves retention, drives innovation, and proves accessibility is intelligent business design.

Phone: 447723782430

Mike Armstrong

Founder, MAN Media Global

An Entrepreneur from the age of 11 whos had a very varied and interesting Career and entrepreneurial journey who likes to breathe fire in to the next generation of Entrepreneurs via motivation, inspiration and educational content in many formats!

Phone: 447487755161

Sam Bowen

Creative Director, Fresh Faced Marketing

I am the creative director at Fresh Faced with my role consisting of positioning our clients content inline with the strategy we provide. It's all about ensure our clietns are deploying their marketing budget in the right departments to ensure ROI

Phone: 447576206783

Continued on next page...

Bradley Bunce
Founder, Unifying Services Ltd

Bradley Bunce is the Founder and Director of Unifying Services Ltd, a Cardiff-founded startup rethinking how local businesses measure marketing performance.

Phone: 447427393958

11:45 AM - 12:15 PM

John Attridge
CEO, BBX UK

Session: Stop doing dumb things

EMCEE INTRO
Our next speaker combines business ownership, leadership insight, and award-winning speaking into one powerful session.
He’s a best-selling author and seasoned entrepreneur who challenges leaders to rethink the mistakes that limit growth.
Please welcome the CEO of BBX UK — John Attridge.

About the Speaker
John Attridge is a business owner, cricket umpire, award-winning speaker, and best-selling author. Known for his practical and direct leadership advice, he helps business owners think smarter about scaling and exit strategies.

About the Session
This session delivers insights on how to grow, scale, and exit an eight-figure business. John will highlight the common mistakes leaders make — and the smarter decisions that drive long-term success.

Speaker Contact
Phone: 447799717627

Continued on next page...

PANEL DISCUSSION 2

Technology, AI & Business Efficiency

The Businesses Winning in 2026 Are Building Systems, Not Just Services

12:15 PM - 01:00 PM | Main Keynote Stage

About the Panel

Why the Businesses Winning in 2026 Are Building Systems, Not Just Services. AI is no longer the advantage. Operational efficiency is. The businesses scaling fastest are redesigning workflows, customer experiences, decision-making, and internal operations around intelligent systems and automation. Meanwhile, many businesses are still using disconnected AI tools without creating real operational transformation. This panel explores how SMEs and scaling businesses can use AI strategically to improve efficiency, reduce friction, and build long-term competitive advantage.

Questions to Address:

1. Where is AI genuinely increasing profitability right now?
2. What business process should every SME automate first?
3. What separates AI experimentation from actual business transformation?
4. Are businesses using AI to improve operations—or avoid fixing broken systems?
5. Which business functions should never be fully automated?
6. Is AI improving customer experience or damaging trust?
7. What operational bottlenecks are slowing business growth today?
8. What competitive advantages will matter most over the next 3 years?

EMCEE INTRO

AI is no longer an advantage.
Operational efficiency is.
The fastest-scaling businesses are redesigning workflows, customer experiences, decision-making, and internal operations around intelligent systems and automation.
Meanwhile, many businesses are still using disconnected AI tools without creating real operational transformation.
This panel explores how SMEs and scaling businesses can use AI strategically to improve efficiency, reduce friction, and build long-term competitive advantage.

Continued on next page...

Panelists

Michael Ramlakhan
Founder & MD, Timeless IMS

Michael Ramlakhan, with 33+ years of experience & founder of Timeless IMS, helps SMEs grow through tailored, proactive technology solutions. He champions cost-effective, enterprise-grade service, focusing on security, stability, and client understanding.

Phone: 447869145163

Anayo Oleru
Technical Co-Founder, Civeex

Anayo Oleru is a software engineer, AI product builder, Google mentor, and international conference speaker with over seven years of experience developing scalable software solutions. He is the co-founder and Technical Team Lead at Civeex.

Phone: 447823702251

Estelle Cartlidge
Founder / CEO, My Biz Solution Limited

Estelle is the founder of My Biz Solution, helping SMEs understand how their business really works before making changes. By bringing together people, processes and technology, she helps organisations reduce complexity, improve efficiency and build businesses that are easier to run today and ready for whatever comes next.

Phone: 07709642425

Gweirydd Davies
Strategic Director, Pobl Tech (Known as Pobl)

Gweirydd Ioan Davies is a Director of Pobl, a Cardiff-based creative technology agency. He leads the agency’s strategy, new business and client partnerships, helping organisations turn complex challenges into clear, practical digital projects.

Phone: 07791937843

Continued on next page...

Lucy Stagg
Director, Atradius Collections

Lucy has extensive experience in credit management, collections, and customer risk. She is passionate about supporting businesses through challenging economic conditions and regularly contributes to industry discussions and events across the UK.

Phone: 02920824864

Mohammed Ullah
Founder & Director, Specs Oncall

Mohammed Ullah is a GOC-registered optometrist and founder of Specs Oncall, an NHS-approved mobile optical service.
After recognising the difficulties many people face accessing traditional eye care, Mohammed founded Specs Oncall to bring professional eye care services directly to homes, care homes and workplaces.
Through building and growing the business, he has developed a strong interest in using technology to solve the challenges of delivering mobile healthcare at scale

Phone: 07501782289

01:00 PM - 01:30 PM

Michael Ramlakhan
Founder & MD, Timeless IMS

Session: Most businesses won't be hacked because they are advanced. They will be hacked because they are careless. That's the uncomfortable truth

EMCEE INTRO
Our next keynote speaker is an IT veteran with over 33 years of experience helping small and medium enterprises grow through tailored, proactive technology solutions.
Please welcome the visionary founder of Timeless IMS, Michael Ramlakhan!

About the Speaker
Michael Ramlakhan, with 33+ years of experience & founder of Timeless IMS, helps SMEs grow through tailored, proactive technology solutions. He champions cost-effective, enterprise-grade service, focusing on security, stability, and client understanding.

Continued on next page...

About the Session

Most cyberattacks succeed because of simple human mistakes—not sophisticated hackers. Michael reveals how rushed clicks, weak passwords, and ignored warnings lead to major breaches, and how leaders can build a security-first culture that turns people from the weakest link into the strongest defense.

Speaker Contact

Phone: 447869145163

Continued on next page...

PANEL DISCUSSION 3

Sales, Partnerships & Revenue Growth

The Trust Economy: Why Relationships Are Outperforming Traditional Sales

01:30 PM - 02:15 PM | Main Keynote Stage

About the Panel

The Trust Economy: Why Relationships Are Outperforming Traditional Sales. Buyers have changed. Customers are researching businesses long before meetings happen. Cold outreach is becoming less effective. Trust, credibility, partnerships, and reputation now influence buying decisions before conversations even begin. The businesses growing fastest in 2026 are building ecosystems, communities, strategic partnerships, and authority-driven sales environments instead of relying purely on traditional outbound tactics.

Questions to Address:

1. Where are the highest-quality leads actually coming from today?
2. Are partnerships outperforming outbound sales strategies?
3. Why are some businesses generating leads but struggling to close?
4. What creates buying confidence before meetings even happen?
5. Are businesses becoming too dependent on paid lead generation?
6. How important are communities and networking ecosystems in modern growth?
7. What sales tactic is becoming obsolete in 2026?
8. What's shortening sales cycles right now without discounting?

EMCEE INTRO

Buyers have changed.
Customers are researching businesses long before meetings happen.
Cold outreach is becoming less effective.
Trust, credibility, partnerships, and reputation now influence buying decisions before conversations even begin.
The businesses growing fastest in 2026 are building ecosystems, communities, strategic partnerships, and authority-driven sales environments instead of relying purely on traditional outbound tactics.

Continued on next page...

Panelists

Jamie Martin
Sales and Account Manager, Digitex Technologies

As Business Development Manager for Digitex Technologies, Jamie Martin provides Digital Marketing solutions (price for value is unrivalled) to SMEs-Corporate companies across a range of industries and for products or services.

Phone: 07599332178

Tracy Ho
Founder, Frame & Fame Personal Branding

Tracy Ho is an Executive Presence Coach & Personal Branding Strategist helping professionals & entrepreneurs communicate their value more clearly, strengthen visibility, & build greater confidence, credibility, & influence for their business growth.

Phone: 447473686361

Elena Apalkova
Founder and CEO, Mindset2Results Ltd

Elena Apalkova is a business psychology and human potential expert, keynote speaker, transformational mentor, and the Founder & CEO of Mindset2Results and The Circle of Fame. She specialises in helping entrepreneurs, business owners, and leaders.

Phone: 07493885642

Julie Wong
Founder, PJL

Julie has 30 years experience in finance across multiple industries from FTSE blue chip to SMEs. She now works with SMEs to build resilient businesses with strong financial foundations to make the best strategic decisions to grow sustainably.

Phone: 07876761664

Continued on next page...

Aled Nelmes
Founder & CEO, Lumen SEO

Born in Abergavenny and made in Cardiff, Aled is the founder of Lumen SEO and is driven by generating commercial success with people-first strategies.

Phone: 07711052167

Anna Lloyd-Owen
Director, Cwtchie Ltd

I’m the Co-Founder and Director of Cwtchie, a Welsh lifestyle brand that began with creating cosy hoodie blankets people would love but has grown into a wider collection of Welsh-designed lifestyle products, including accessories and thermal bottles.

Phone: 07531304885

02:15 PM - 02:45 PM

Des O'Connor
Director, DesOConnor.ai

Session: Top 10 Free AI Tools To Supercharge Your Services and Business

EMCEE INTRO
AI does not have to be expensive to be powerful.
Our next speaker focuses on practical tools that can be implemented immediately—without heavy investment.
Please welcome Des O’Connor.

About the Speaker
Des O’Connor is an AI consultant focused on helping entrepreneurs and business owners improve productivity, visibility, and sales through accessible AI tools. His approach is practical, implementation-focused, and results-driven.

About the Session
This session delivers exactly what most businesses need: usable tools. You will walk away with a curated list of 10 free AI tools, including how to use them, where they apply, and how they impact business performance. No theory—just execution.

Continued on next page...

Speaker Contact

Phone: 447956566083

PANEL DISCUSSION 4

Finance, Investment & Business Risk

Growth Without Stability Is Dangerous: The Scale-Up Reality Nobody Talks About

02:45 PM - 03:30 PM | Main Keynote Stage

About the Panel

Growth Without Stability Is Dangerous: The Scale-Up Reality Nobody Talks About.
Revenue growth can hide serious problems. Many businesses struggle not because demand disappears — but because margins shrink, operational costs rise, cash flow weakens, and scaling pressure quietly damages the business underneath the surface. This panel explores the financial realities of sustainable business growth in uncertain economic conditions.

Questions to Address:

1. What financial mistake is hurting SMEs most right now?
2. Is aggressive scaling becoming overrated?
3. What matters more in 2026: profitability, valuation, or resilience?
4. Where are businesses underestimating operational costs while scaling?
5. Are businesses growing revenue while quietly destroying margins?
6. At what stage does taking investment become dangerous?
7. What creates long-term financial stability during uncertain markets?
8. If you had to prepare for the next downturn, what would you prioritise first?

EMCEE INTRO

Revenue growth can hide serious problems.
Many businesses struggle not because demand disappears — but because margins shrink, operational costs rise, cash flow weakens, and scaling pressure quietly damages the business underneath the surface.
This panel explores the financial realities of sustainable business growth in uncertain economic conditions.

Continued on next page...

Panelists

John Attridge
CEO, BBX UK

John Attridge is a business owner, cricket umpire, award-winning speaker, and best-selling author. Known for his practical and direct leadership advice, he helps business owners think smarter about scaling and exit strategies.

Phone: 447799717627

Stefania Arca
Director, International Exit Strategy LTD

Stefania Arca is a Strategic Project Manager and the founder of International Exit Strategy. With over 13 years of experience directing £1B+ mega-projects like Heathrow and the US Embassy—Stefania brings enterprise-level operational structure

Phone: 07518808424

Wendy Parker
Founder/CEO, Pink Dandelion Business Services Ltd

Wendy Parker is the founder of Pink Dandelion Business Services, helping SMEs achieve financial clarity, operational efficiency and sustainable growth. She has over 20 years' experience in finance and business operations.

Phone: 07984859031

Elena Apalkova
Founder and CEO, Mindset2Results Ltd

Elena Apalkova is a business psychology and human potential expert, keynote speaker, transformational mentor, and the Founder & CEO of Mindset2Results and The Circle of Fame. She specialises in helping entrepreneurs, business owners, and leaders.

Phone: 07493885642

Continued on next page...

Julie Wong
Founder, PJL

Julie has 30 years experience in finance across multiple industries from FTSE blue chip to SMEs. She now works with SMEs to build resilient businesses with strong financial foundations to make the best strategic decisions to grow sustainably.

Phone: 07876761664

Lucy Stagg
Director, Atradius Collections

Lucy has extensive experience in credit management, collections, and customer risk. She is passionate about supporting businesses through challenging economic conditions and regularly contributes to industry discussions and events across the UK.

Phone: 02920824864

03:30 PM - 04:00 PM

Rahim Bah
Founder & CEO, Framego

About the Speaker
Rahim Bah is an entrepreneur and the Founder of FrameGo, an on-demand platform connecting businesses with professional photographers and videographers.
The idea came from a very real frustration.
During a business trip to Edinburgh, Rahim needed a videographer at short notice. Unable to find someone locally, he eventually brought a videographer from Cardiff and spent more than £1,000 for a short filming session.

Speaker Contact
Phone: +447961234080